(v) Special problems of Tribal Development.

In respect of *agriculture*, the Mid-Term Appraisal notes that though agriculture performance and the rate of growth in the Eleventh Plan is likely to be better than that in the Tenth Plan, it may, however, not reach the target of 4% per year. The need for attention to agriculture and other critical issues mentioned above would require *concerted action* by the Centre and the States.

The Review by the PC regarding the **Poverty Estimates** is also important when the issue has become a matter of debate in the country. The Planning Commission is the nodal agency for estimating poverty in the country both at national level and across the States. The Planning Commission estimates the poverty on the basis of poverty line defined in terms of monthly per capita consumption expenditure. The Commission has been estimating poverty line and poverty ratio since 1997 on the basis of the methodology contained in the report of the Expert Group on 'Estimation of Number and Proportion of Poor' (known as *Lakdawala Committee Report*). The Head-count poverty ratio has been estimated by using the above mentioned poverty lines from a large size sample survey of household consumption expenditure carried out by the National Sample Survey Office with an interval of 5 years approximately.

The Planning Commission constituted an Expert Group in December, 2005 under the chairmanship of Prof. Suresh D Tendulkar to review the methodology for estimation of poverty. The Expert Group submitted its report in December 2009. While acknowledging the multi dimensional nature of poverty, the Expert Group recommended moving away from anchoring the poverty lines to the calorie intake norm, adopting the Mixed Reference Period (MRP) based estimates of consumption expenditure as the basis for future poverty lines, adopting MRP equivalent of urban Poverty Line Basket (PLB) corresponding to 25.7% urban headcount ratio as the new reference PLB for rural areas. On the basis of above methodology, the all-India rural poverty headcount ratio for 2004-05 was estimated at 41.8 %, urban poverty headcount ratio at 25.7% and all India level at 37.2%. It may however be mentioned that the Tendulkar Committee's estimates are not strictly comparable to the present official poverty estimates because of different methodologies. As has been indicated in the Mid Term Appraisal